

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 5

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 8 6 4

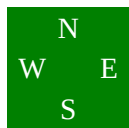
♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 6 4

♥ A K 3

♦ K J 10 2

♣ A 8 7



♠ A 7 2

♥ Q J 10 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 9 3

♠ K Q 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ 6 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=4 ♣=1 Total = 7

Needing two more winners you will have to make both the ♠K and ♠Q. This will only be possible if East holds the ♠A. Win the first trick (if you don't East might switch to ♣s) and play a small ♠ toward dummy's ♠Q. It holds the trick.

You should take your four ♦ winners now, being sure to end up in your hand. Then play another small ♠ toward dummy's ♠K. This also wins.

You have now won 7 tricks so don't mess around now. Take your two Aces and let them have the last four tricks.

If West held the ♠A you would not have made the contract.

A Simple Finesse has only a 50% success rate. That's why we only take finesses as a last resort.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4 3

♥ 9 8 2

♦ K J 6 3

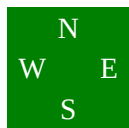
♣ J 9 7

♠ 9 8 6

♥ A K Q J 4

♦ A 7 4

♣ A 2



♠ K J 5 2

♥ 7 5 3

♦ Q 10

♣ K Q 10 5

♠ A Q 7

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 8 5 2

♣ 8 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South
other half they lose.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦ 3.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=5 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 8

You need just one more winner. Since West probably has 4 ♦s you will not be able to establish a trick in that suit, so your only hope is the ♠Q. You win the first ♦ so they don't get a chance to switch to ♣s, a suit you are worse off in. Then take your 5 ♥ tricks, ending in dummy.

You can't put it off any longer so play a small ♠ from dummy and put the ♠Q on. If it wins you will make your contract, if it loses you won't.

East held the ♠K so you were lucky this time.

But remember, finesses only work half the time. The